

LESSON TWELVE

TOPIC: DIVORCE

TEXT: MATTHEW 19:3-10, MALACHI 2:13-16

MEMORY VERSE: MALACHI 2:16 The man who hates and divorces his wife", says the Lord, the God of Israel, 'Does violence to the one he should protect'.....

CENTRAL TRUTH: It is essential to affirm that God's intention is not for Christian couples to divorce, as stated in Matthew 19:8, "... but from the beginning it was not so ..."

INTRODUCTION: Couples intending to marry should share the same faith and purpose. There are several reasons why God discourages divorce. Firstly, He desires a godly offering, as indicated in Malachi 2:15. Secondly, He aims to prevent violence and its repercussions, as noted in Malachi 2:16. Divorce is not the unforgivable sin; rather, it is the rejection of Christ that holds that distinction. Marriage should not be viewed as a matter of life and death.

Lesson Outline

1. Hardness of heart: Matthew 19:8-9

In the context of hardness of heart, Moses "permitted" a means of escape for individuals. This hardness can manifest in various forms, including abuse, a blatant refusal to uphold the marital covenant, and a lack of sexual purity and unity.

2. It is not the Will of God: Matthew 19:3-5.

God's design is for a man to cleave to his wife, resulting in their becoming one. Refer to Matthew 19:4-5, which states, "They are no longer two but one flesh; what God has joined together, let no one separate."

3. Allow for reconciliation: 1 Corinthians 7:10-12, 2 Corinthians 5:18-19

Marriage entails a commitment to seek reconciliation at all costs. Repentance and reconciliation are always the most favorable paths forward. However, a believer who is abandoned by an unbelieving spouse "is not bound" (1 Corinthians 7:15). Sin taints every Garden of Eden—therefore, avoid sin and cherish your marriage and spouse.

QUESTION: If a spouse becomes born again, how should she interact with her unbelieving spouse? 1 Corinthians 7:13-14

CONCLUSION: Although divorce is a challenging experience, it does not equate to condemnation. God's grace and restoration are accessible to those who have gone through divorce, offering hope for healing and progression. Romans 8:1.